

Fulbright University Vietnam



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Game: Phương Mai

Group 5

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Report

I. Problem statement:

Although there are multiple communication channels to spread events at campus like Outlook emails, Onestop calendar, or offline posters, Fulbright students frequently miss campus events. These channels are fragmented and easily ignored because of low engagement; this creates a bottleneck which prevents events' notifications from reaching students effectively.

As a result, student clubs or departments who want to promote their events in the Fulbright community experience low participation despite the quality of events and high promotional efforts, while students ignore and miss opportunities in campus life. This leads to inefficient use of time, resources, and communication effort.

II. Insights:

Insights will be synthesized into two main categories: students' insights and event organizers' insights.

1. Students:

- a. Insight 1: Event awareness failure is widespread, even among interested students
 - Students often miss campus events not because of low of interests or bad quality, but because existing communication channels fail to surface relevant information effectively.
 - 70% of survey respondents reported having missed campus events in which they were interested.

→ This indicates a systemic visibility problem rather than a demand problem. Students are open to participating, but event information does not reliably reach them at the right time or in the right form.
- b. Insight 2: Outlook emails suffer from severe attention overload
 - Email remains the dominant communication channel, but inbox overload significantly reduces its effectiveness for event promotion.
 - Only 40% of students regularly read Outlook emails from departments, while the remaining 60% read them only sometimes or rarely.
 - 100% of respondents agreed that they miss event emails due to receiving too many emails daily from multiple sources.

→ Emails compete with academic and administrative messages that students consider as higher priority. As a result, event-related emails are often ignored before their content is even evaluated.
- c. Insight 3: Passive channels (posters, OneStop) fail to drive active discovery
 - Both physical and digital platforms requires much effort from students to be effective discovery tools
 - Only 40% of students regularly pay attention to offline posters, while 30% rarely notice them.
 - Only 20% of students actively access OneStop to check the events calendar, while 40% rarely do so.

→ Students are unlikely to actively browse platforms or physical spaces solely to look for events. Channels which rely on intentional searching create friction and are poorly aligned with actual student behavior.
- d. Insight 4: Information overload reduces motivation to explore events
 - An excessive volume of event information discourages students from engaging with event content in the first place.
 - 80% of respondents felt that there are too many events, making it difficult to identify which ones are interesting or relevant.

→ When faced with too many options and little guidance, students disengage entirely. This highlights the need for lightweight filtering, prioritization, or contextual presentation of event information.
- e. Insight 5: Students respond positively to playful and low-effort discovery formats
 - Students show openness to alternative, game-based formats for discovering event information, especially when positioned as relaxing and time-efficient.

- 40% of students said they want to try a Fulbright-like campus simulation game, and an additional 50% responded “maybe.”
- 80% believe such a game would be fun and relaxing.
- 60% prefer mini-games which are quick and easy to play.

→ While not all students are immediately convinced, the majority are at least curious. This suggests that engagement-first experiences can lower resistance and create opportunities for passive information discovery.

➡ Together, these insights suggest that the core challenge is not persuading students to care about events, but designing a discovery system that fits naturally into their attention patterns. This directly motivates the exploration of a low-friction, game-based platform that embeds event information within an engaging campus experience.

2. Event organizers, including students club and departments:

- a. Insight 1: Organizers define success by participation, not content quality alone
 - For event organizers, a successful event is one that attracts a sufficient number of participants, regardless of the effort invested in content quality.
 - Organizers emphasized that events are considered successful when they feature qualified content and achieve strong attendance (Wellness Center).

→ This highlights a gap between content preparation and outcome. Even well-designed events fail to meet success criteria if promotion does not translate into attendance.

- b. Insight 2: Over-reliance on email and calendar invitations reduces effectiveness
 - Frequent use of email announcements and calendar invitations contributes to information dilution rather than improved visibility.
 - Organizers often send repeated emails and calendar invites to increase awareness, unintentionally adding to inbox overload (CEI).

→ Instead of increasing reach, repeated notifications may reduce impact, reinforcing the same attention bottleneck identified on the student side.

- c. Insight 3: Offline posters are acceptable but limited in reach
 - Physical posters are seen as a baseline promotional tool, but their impact is constrained by visibility and saturation (the board where posters are hung at campus is full of posters and banners).
 - Organizers consider posters “okay” but acknowledge that crowded bulletin boards limit their effectiveness.

→ Posters function as passive reinforcement rather than primary discovery channels.

- d. Insight 4: Offline booths are engaging but resource-intensive
 - In-person booths are perceived as highly engaging, yet costly in terms of time, effort, and financial resources.
 - Organizers noted that booths require staffing, setup time, and budget, making them difficult to scale across multiple events.

→ This creates a trade-off between engagement quality and operational sustainability.

➡ Together, these insights reveal that organizers do not lack commitment or content, but rather effective, scalable, and measurable ways to reach students' attention.

3. Cross-stakeholder insights:

Students	Event Organizers (Clubs & Departments)
Frequently miss campus events they are genuinely interested in	Struggle to attract sufficient participants despite high-quality event content
Experience inbox overload and tend to ignore Outlook newsletters	Rely heavily on repeated emails and calendar invitations to increase visibility
Rarely access OneStop solely to browse event calendars	Lack alternative centralized channels to promote events effectively
Find physical posters easy to ignore due to saturation on bulletin boards	View posters as acceptable but limited in reach
Respond poorly to high-effort discovery (scrolling, searching)	Offline booths are engaging but costly in time, effort, and budget
Feel overwhelmed by the number of events, leading to disengagement	Have limited visibility into which promotion methods actually work
Prefer lightweight, fun, and low-effort ways to encounter information	Need scalable, sustainable promotion methods
Open to playful or game-based discovery formats if time-efficient	Seek measurable indicators of interest (views, clicks, engagement)

Table 1. Cross-stakeholder insights

→ While students seek effortless and engaging ways to discover relevant events, organizers focus on maximizing reach and participation with limited resources. This misalignment reveals a systemic gap between how event information is distributed and how students actually consume it.

III. Current system:

Current System Flow: Campus Event Communication

Event organizers (student clubs and departments)

Create events content	
(event details, posters, email copy, links)	
↓	
Distribution channels	
1. Digital	2. Physical
Outlook emails / newsletters	Campus posters/bulletin boards
Outlook calendar invitations	Offline booths in common areas
OneStop event listings	
↓	
Students' exposure	
Email inbox (mixed with academic/admin emails)	
OneStop (accessed mainly for administrative tasks)	
Physical spaces (hallways, common areas)	
Peer-to-peer sharing (word of mouth)	
↓	
Students' Attention and Behavior	
Skim or ignore non-urgent emails	
Rarely browse events intentionally	
Overlook posters due to saturation	
Discover events inconsistently	
↓	
Outcomes	
Uneven event awareness	
Missed relevant events	
Low or unpredictable participation	
Limited feedbacks to organizers	

Table 2. Current system flow

Based on the insights and the current system flow, we discovered some bottlenecks within the system:

- Attention bottleneck: inbox overload at the “Student Exposure” stage
- Effort bottleneck: intentional browsing required at OneStop
- Visibility bottleneck: poster saturation in physical spaces
- Feedback bottleneck: no clear signal of what channels worked

IV. Our goals:

Primary product goal: Increase event visibility through active discovery:

Instead of students passively receiving information (email/poster), the product puts them into an “exploration mode” where they *choose* to approach checkpoints and interact, so they’re more willing to stop and read.

Secondary product goal: Make discovery engaging enough to sustain attention:

We design the experience to feel familiar + playful (a Fulbright-like campus simulation), so users can “relate” quickly and stay longer once they reach interesting areas and interactions.

Measurement goal: Prove visibility + engagement with real usage data

In MVP/pilot, we optimize for measurable signals:

- **Visibility:** checkpoint opens / poster views / document opens
- **Engagement:** mini-game starts/completions/failures, time spent, interactions per session.
- **Return-to-play:** repeat sessions driven by novelty updates (rotating games/content). (This also supports the course bonus requirement to iterate from usage tracking.)

V. Users + Jobs-To-Be-Done:

1) Students (primary users)

Context: Busy inboxes + high friction to “search” for events → low motivation to check OneStop/newsletters/physical posters

JTBD:

- *When I’m stressed and overwhelmed, I want an engaging and fun way to discover what’s happening on campus, so I don’t miss opportunities without doing extra work.*
- *When I’m in a playful/exploration mood, I want the campus experience to feel familiar and fun, so I’m willing to stay and interact longer.*
- *When I see an event, I want to understand “Is this for me?” quickly, so I can decide in under 10 seconds whether to take further action.*

2) Student clubs & Departments (clients)

Context: *They already have content, but reach/attention is the bottleneck.*

JTBD:

- *When we publish an event, we want a channel that reliably reaches students, so our promotion effort doesn't get wasted.*
- *When we promote through a new channel, we want simple analytics (views/interactions), so we can learn what works and justify resources.*

VI. Product detail:

Product format: “Interactive campus map + event checkpoints”

The MVP is a browser-based mini-game where students move a character around a Fulbright-like map and discover interactive hotspots (“checkpoints”) that reveal event information and/or launch a short challenge.

Core experience components

- 1. Familiar campus simulation (relatable + playful):** The map mimics campus spaces and objects to create “close-to-home” immersion, helping users quickly understand the context and feel curious to explore.
- 2. Exploration-driven discovery (active attention, not passive exposure):** Players navigate using **WASD / Arrow keys** and receive prompts when near checkpoints.
- 3. Event delivery formats:**
 - Interaction-based (Iteration #1): event info embedded inside a mini-challenge to increase interaction time and memorability.
- 4. Diverse mini-game concepts (Iteration #2: novelty to drive return):**
 - Classroom 1 map includes multiple mini-games (keyboard challenge, balance game, shooter) selectable at a single checkpoint.
 - Makerspace includes time-based interaction challenges (e.g., cleaning rush) with retry loops.
- 5. Built-in feedback + analytics (so this is a measurable product)**
 - Analytics scripts are integrated (GoatCounter + GA4) to track actions and engagement.
 - The product logs interaction events like poster views and document opens, enabling visibility metrics for organizers.
 - A Feedback Form button exists in the UI for quick qualitative input.

VII. Event delivery formats (A/B testing)

Objective:

Optimize the delivery of event information so that students pay more attention, engage

actively, and remember key details, while also providing opportunities for direct action (e.g., registering).

A/B Test Design:

- **Event Checkpoint A in Common Area (Control):** Displays only basic event information.
- **Event Checkpoint B in Makerspace (Treatment):** Displays event information + “Register” button + “Play Challenge” button (mini-game).

Feature Highlight:

- Encourages active engagement rather than passive reading.
- Mini-game and interactive buttons extend the total interaction time with the checkpoint and reinforce retention of key information.

Results:

- After interviewing 9 participants who played the game, 6 out of 9 ($\approx 67\%$) reported that they noticed Checkpoint B more and retained more key information compared to Checkpoint A.
- This shows that integrating interactive buttons and mini-challenges increases awareness and improves the ability to remember important event details.

Insights:

- Integrating interactive buttons and mini-challenges makes the checkpoint more engaging and enhances retention of event information.
- This approach can be extended to other checkpoints, supporting a strategy of exploration-driven event discovery across the campus map.

VIII. User journey

The user journey (image below) highlights several critical touchpoints where the product directly addresses the core failures of Fulbright’s existing event communication channels.

The entry touchpoint is where the product solves the attention problem. Unlike emails, calendars, or posters that rely on clarity and intentional reading, the website is intentionally visually dense and confusing. This design disrupts passive consumption and captures attention during low-effort moments. By triggering curiosity rather than demanding comprehension, the product succeeds where traditional channels are easily ignored.

The exploration touchpoint demonstrates the shift from passive exposure to active discovery. As users begin clicking image-based checkpoints, engagement increases through voluntary interaction. Event information is encountered through play rather than pushed through

text-heavy formats, directly addressing the problem of students not actively searching for events.

The interactive checkpoint touchpoint solves the relevance and cognitive overload issue. Each checkpoint embeds event information into short, playful interactions, allowing students to assess relevance within seconds. This replaces long emails or calendar descriptions with fast, low-friction decision-making while maintaining engagement.

The action touchpoint addresses the drop-off between awareness and attendance. Immediate registration and calendar actions are available at the moment of engagement, reducing the likelihood that students forget events after discovery, an issue common in poster- or email-based systems.

Finally, the analytics and feedback touchpoint solves the measurement gap for organizers. Unlike traditional channels that provide little insight into visibility or engagement, the platform tracks interactions, views, and engagement time. This enables scalable evaluation of event communication effectiveness without increasing operational cost.

Together, these key touchpoints demonstrate how the product transforms event discovery into an engaging, measurable process, delivering high engagement without high operational effort and filling the attention gap left by existing communication channels.

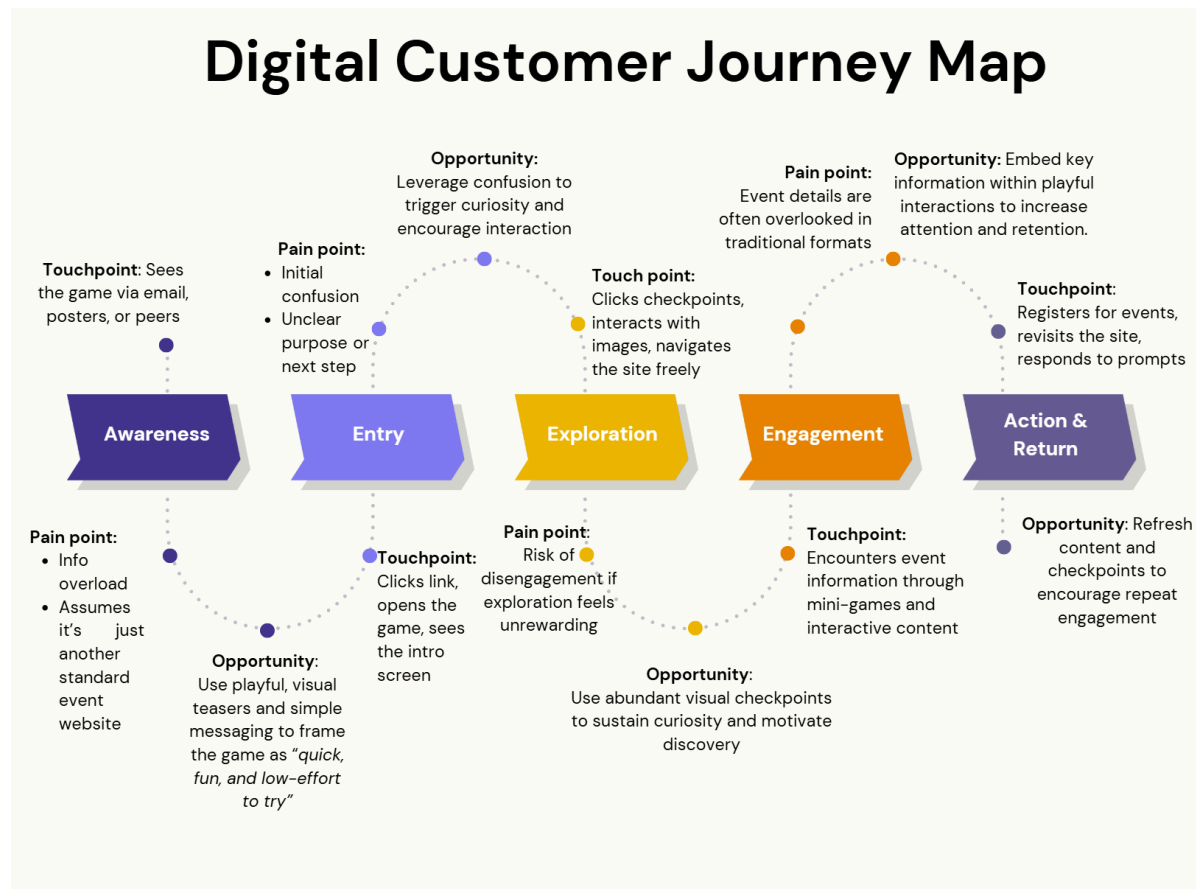


Figure 1. Customer Journey Map

IX. Value proposition

The proposed interactive campus map game addresses the systemic gaps in Fulbright’s existing event communication ecosystem by transforming event discovery from a passive, easily ignored process into an **active, engaging, and measurable experience**.

1. Voluntary, attention-first discovery: Unlike emails, calendars, or posters that interrupt students during cognitively overloaded moments, the product is entered voluntarily as a playful campus exploration. This places students in a cognitively open state, making them more receptive to event information. As a result, events are far less likely to be ignored at first contact.

2. Events discovered through interaction, not information push: Event information is embedded into short, interactive checkpoints rather than pushed as dense text. Students encounter events while exploring and can judge relevance within seconds, reducing cognitive friction and increasing dwell time. Discovery becomes experiential rather than passive scanning.

3. High engagement at digital scale, with measurable impact: The platform delivers booth-level engagement without the operational cost of physical presence. It scales to any number of students online while providing built-in analytics on visibility, interaction, and engagement – insights that existing channels cannot reliably offer.

X. Competitor analysis

Our product does not explicitly compete in the traditional market with multiple solutions available to solve the same problem. Rather, we focus it on the Fulbright context, where the core issue is the ineffectiveness of existing channels. Below is the table comparing the gaps in existing systems and how we stand out as a complementary solution.

Criteria	Game Phương Mai	Outlook	OneStop	Posters	Booths
Easy to Get Noticed	✓	✗	✗	✗	○
Discovery-Based	✓	✗	✗	✗	○
High Engagement Experience	✓	✗	✗	✗	○
Fast Relevance Check	✓	○	✗	○	○

Measurable Impact	✓	✗	✗	✗	✗
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Table 3: Competitor Analysis

We analyze current event communication at Fulbright, including Outlook emails, OneStop event calendar, Offline posters, In-person booths. The comparison focuses on five criteria that directly reflect the root problem identified in user research: attention loss, passive consumption, cognitive overload, and lack of feedback.

Attention in low-effort moments

Outlook emails and OneStop suffer from attention overload, as event information competes with academic and administrative content. Posters depend on physical proximity and chance, while booths require high effort and presence at the right time. In contrast, the proposed product is intentionally designed to capture attention during low-effort, optional moments by framing discovery as play rather than obligation.

Active discovery vs. passive exposure

Existing channels primarily push information toward students, assuming they will read, scan, or search intentionally. However, research shows that students rarely engage in active searching for events. The proposed product shifts this dynamic by encouraging exploration-driven discovery, where students encounter event information through interaction with the campus map and checkpoints.

Engagement experience

Most existing channels feel like administrative tasks rather than engaging experiences. Even booths, while interactive, demand significant time, staffing, and resources. The proposed solution differentiates itself by offering a lightweight, playful experience that lowers psychological resistance and sustains attention through mini-games and exploration mechanics.

Speed of relevance judgment

A key failure of current channels is the lack of quick relevance cues. Emails, calendars, and posters often require students to read substantial content before deciding whether an event is for them. The proposed product embeds event information into short interactions that allow students to understand relevance in under 10 seconds, reducing decision friction.

Measurable engagement and visibility

Existing channels provide little to no actionable feedback for event organizers. Email open rates, poster visibility, and booth effectiveness are difficult to quantify reliably. The proposed product introduces built-in analytics that track views, interactions, and engagement time, enabling organizers to understand what content reaches students and how they interact with it.

The product differentiates itself by transforming event awareness from a passive, easily ignored process into an interactive experience aligned with real student behavior.

To synthesize these differences at a system level, we map existing channels and the proposed product onto a competitor landscape using two dimensions: student engagement and event invisibility (image below).

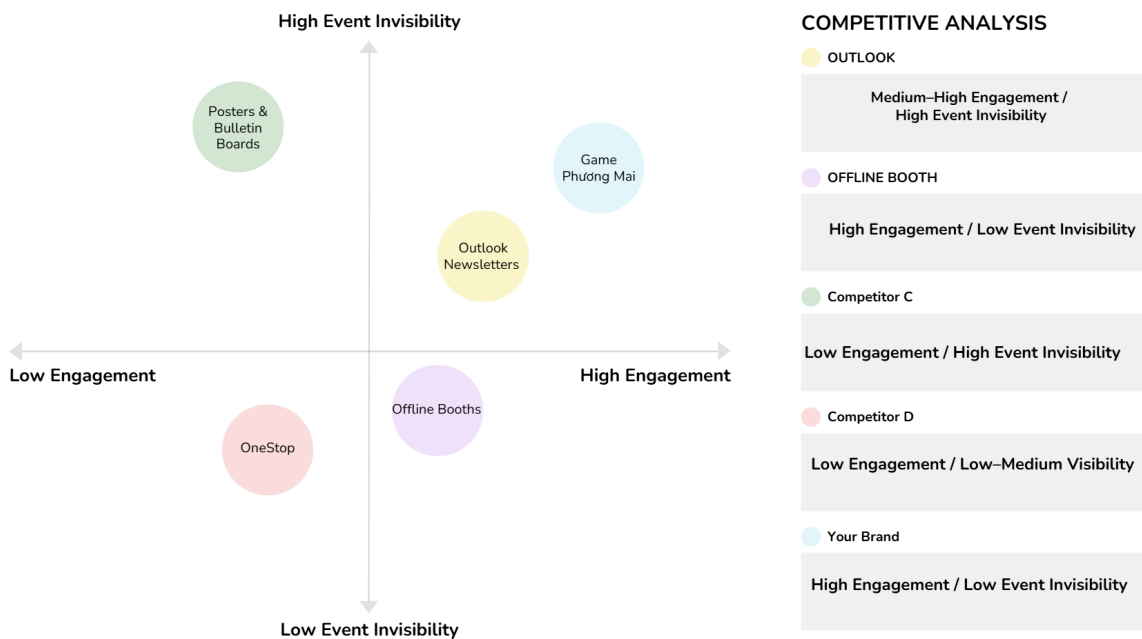


Figure 2. Competitor Analysis using 2x2 matrix

Competitive positioning

Overall, these channels are widely available and familiar, but they were not designed with attention, engagement, or discovery behavior as their primary goal. They either maximize reach at the cost of attention or create engagement at the cost of scalability. The proposed product does not aim to replace these channels, but to complement them by addressing a persistent gap: enabling engaging, low-effort, and measurable event discovery. By transforming event awareness from a passive process into an interactive experience, the product occupies a distinct position within the campus communication ecosystem.

XI. MVP

1. MVP scope:

Must-have (v1 / pilot)

- **Interactive campus map (2 spaces):** Common Area hub + 1–2 locations (Classroom 1, Makerspace)
- **Basic movement + exploration:** simple controls, collision boundaries, smooth navigation
- **Event checkpoints:** interactive hotspots that reveal event info (poster/info card/PDF)
- **At least 1 interaction-based checkpoint:** a short challenge linked to an event (play → reveal/confirm → CTA)
- **Clear CTA option:** link out to register / learn more (minimum: open link)
- **Basic instrumentation:** track checkpoint views, mini-game starts/completions, and return sessions
- **Feedback capture:** simple in-game feedback form link

Nice-to-have (not required for MVP)

- Points/badges/collectibles
- Leaderboard
- Personalization by major/interests
- Progressive map unlocking
- Organizer admin dashboard (upload events)
- Social sharing / friend invites

2. User flow

Players will start in a main lobby (the Common Area), where they can freely walk around to discover and interact with various checkpoints that branch into other maps, such as Classroom 1 and the Makerspace. Each map contains multiple checkpoints that introduce different non-player characters, each with relatable stories and fun minigames for players to enjoy. Information about

upcoming school events is integrated throughout these checkpoints as players explore the game. As a result, players will gain a better understanding of upcoming school events, allowing them to participate and avoid missing out.

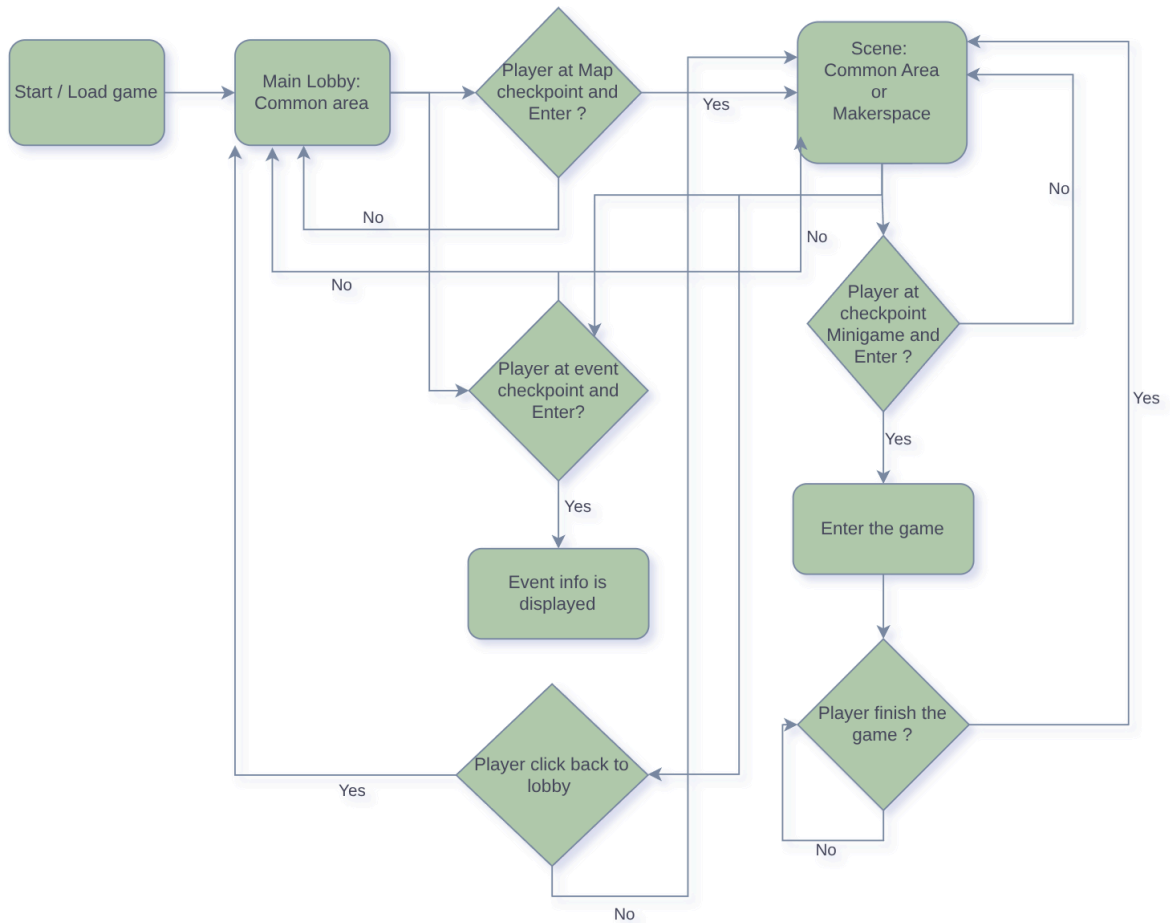


Figure 3. User flow

3. Data tracking:

Google Analytics 4 (GA4) is built into the application to track how users use and interact with the system. It records data for all important actions, and the results are usually available within 24 hours. Every major interaction is tracked in a clear and consistent way, including entering scenes, reaching checkpoints, opening documents, playing mini-games, and tapping maps, buttons, or other on-screen elements. Each action sends an event with a simple, standardized name so the data is easy to understand and analyze. This tracking helps show how users move through the application, what features they use the most, where they stop or drop off, and how engaged they are overall, supporting better decisions and continuous improvement of the experience.

We complement GA4 with GoatCounter, a lightweight privacy-friendly tracker embedded across the site. It provides simple pageview and custom

event counts like newsletter opens or document views so we can quickly gauge traffic and micro-interactions even when we don't need GA4's full analytics stack.

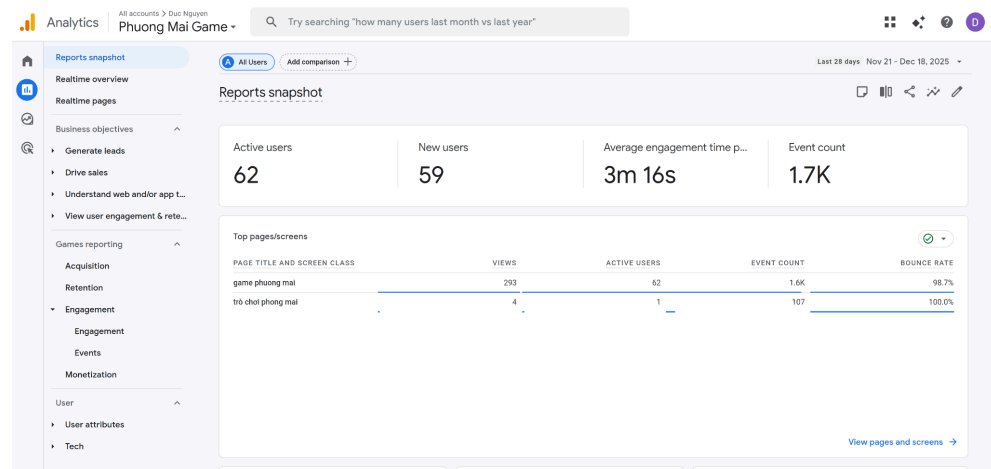


Figure 4. Google Analytics 4's dashboard

XII. QUALITATIVE & QUANTITATIVE DATA AFTER THE FIRST RELEASE:

1. Quantitative Data:

	Event name	Event count	Total users	Event count per active user	Total revenue
☒	Total	1,780 100% of total	63 100% of total	28.25 Avg 0%	₫0
☒	1 page_view	306 (17.19%)	63 (100%)	4.86	₫0 (-)
☒	2 scroll	300 (16.85%)	59 (93.65%)	5.08	₫0 (-)
☒	3 user_engagement	261 (14.66%)	32 (50.79%)	8.16	₫0 (-)
☒	4 minigame_Kera_Candy_Balance	200 (11.24%)	15 (23.81%)	13.33	₫0 (-)
☒	5 checkpoint_Nick_Judy_Table	116 (6.52%)	16 (25.4%)	7.25	₫0 (-)
☐	6 session_start	79 (4.44%)	63 (100%)	1.25	₫0 (-)
☐	7 first_visit	63 (3.54%)	63 (100%)	1.00	₫0 (-)
☐	8 minigame_Keyboard_Shortcuts	61 (3.43%)	17 (26.98%)	3.59	₫0 (-)
☐	9 user_first_visit	61 (3.43%)	61 (96.83%)	1.00	₫0 (-)
☐	10 minigame_Cam_Internship_Shooter	52 (2.92%)	14 (22.22%)	3.71	₫0 (-)
☐	11 minigame_Table_Wipe_Rush	37 (2.08%)	16 (25.4%)	2.31	₫0 (-)
☐	12 user_returned	37 (2.08%)	30 (47.62%)	1.23	₫0 (-)

Figure 5. Google Analytics 4's overview data tracking from December 18

From the figure above, it's obvious that the product reached **306 page views** after 24 hours from **63 unique users**, with 261 user engagement events on the website. Among all features, the Kera Candy Balance mini-game was played more than 200 times, making it the most popular activity. The Keyboard Shortcuts and Cam Shooter mini-games ranked second and third, with 61 and 52 plays, respectively.

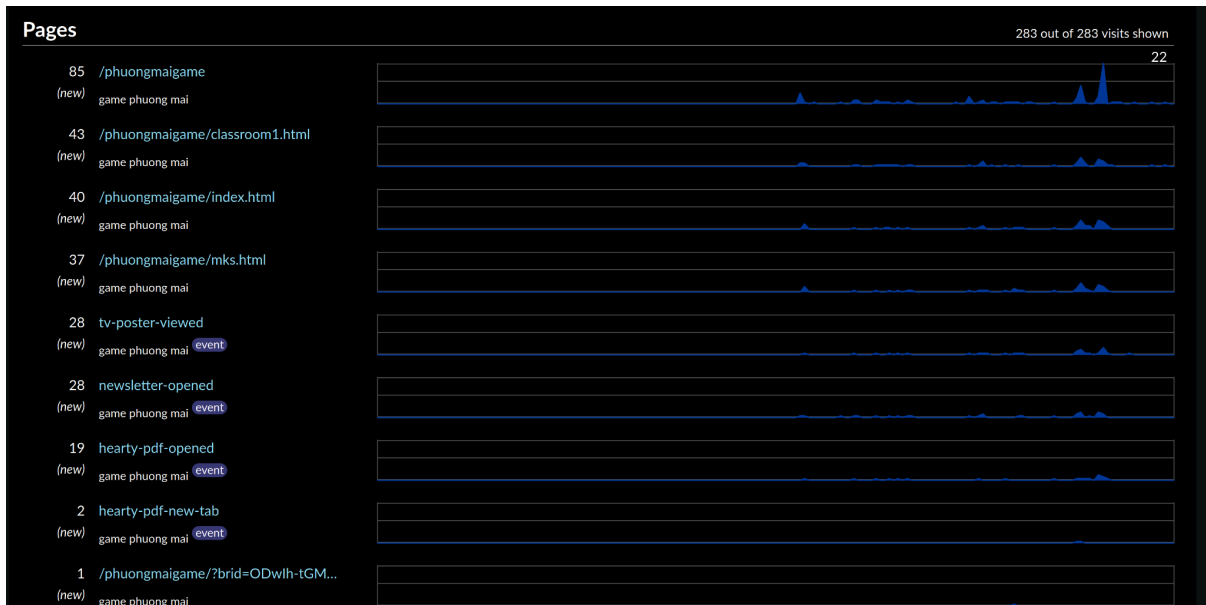


Figure 6. GoatCounter's overview data tracking from December 17 to December 18

Based on the GoatCounter results shown in the figure, the website recorded 283 total visits during the selected time period (Dec 17 to Dec 18). The main entry page, /phuongmaigame, received the highest number of views with 85 visits, which also means that 85 users entered the game. Other important pages such as /phuongmaigame/classroom1.html, and /phuongmaigame/mks.html also attracted a notable number of visits, showing that users explored different maps of the game rather than staying on a single page.

In addition to page views, several tracked events reflect deeper user engagement. The tv-poster-viewed and newsletter-opened events (school events' information) were each triggered 28 times, while the hearty-pdf-opened (hearty plant project's information) occurred 19 times, indicating that users interacted with in-game content and supporting materials. Overall, the results suggest consistent traffic, active navigation across multiple pages, and meaningful user interaction with both gameplay elements and additional resources.

2. Qualitative Data:

Overall first impression

- Users described the experience as “**thú vị**” (interesting) and “**gần gũi**” (familiar/relatable).
- Initial entry felt “okay / not super exciting,” but engagement increased once they explored deeper areas (e.g., Makerspace): the “wow” comes **after** discovery.

What kept users playing

- The strongest driver was **curiosity + exploration**: users enjoyed walking around a Fulbright-like space and “checking every corner.”

- Users said they would return **when there's something new or functional** to check (e.g., updated info, useful content).

Usability & navigation

- Navigation was generally **easy**; users rarely felt stuck.
- Users learned interaction points through **trial-and-error exploration** (walk around → popup appears → interact), rather than instantly recognizing what is clickable.

Event information: visibility vs. recall

- Users **did notice** event information because they actively discovered it (“in explore mode, I’m more willing to read”).
- However, recall was sometimes **shallow**: they remembered **visual cues** (e.g., “green poster”) but not the event content.
- This suggests the product succeeded at **visibility**, but not yet at **making information memorable**.

Behavior after seeing events

- Often, users **read “for knowing”** and did not take further action.
- Reasons included:
 - + They may have already seen the event elsewhere (no urgency/novelty)
 - + **CTA wasn’t strong/clear enough** in the moment
 - + Personal interest and timing still mattered

Key takeaway (what this qualitative round validated)

- The first release successfully put users into an **active discovery mindset**, increasing attention to event info.
- The main gap was converting discovery into **stronger engagement with the information** (time-on-info, recall) and **clear next action** (click/register/save).

XIII. ITERATION

After reviewing the results of the first round of data and interviewing users, our team identified several key points:

- Users tend to stay longer if they feel the game has a “Fulbright” quality and arouses their curiosity.
- However, even if they see event content, they usually only remember the visuals (e.g., “the green poster”) rather than the details, and they don't take any further action.

- Players also shared that they would return if the game had something new or added new features to explore.

Iteration 1: Transitioning from “viewing only” to “interaction”. To address users' tendency to quickly forget information, the team implemented a major change:

Change

- Instead of just displaying posters or information cards as before, the team integrated event content directly into mini-games (users must play → display information → click to register).

Why

- This method helps increase the amount of time users spend engaging with the information and helps them remember it longer, rather than just skimming through it once.
- Discovering events now becomes part of the game rather than feeling like you're being bombarded with ads.

Hypothesis for Data Result #1

- The team believes that this approach will increase clicks on call-to-action buttons and help users remember event information better.

Iteration 2: Add more new games and continuously update content To retain users for the long term, the team focuses on diversity:

Change

- The team added various mini-games and continuously changed the challenge content during the testing process.

Why

- This is to keep the game fresh, prevent users from getting bored, and give them a reason to come back and see “what's new today.”
- Supports return-to-play behavior and repeated exposure to events.

Hypothesis for Data Result #2

- The team hopes that frequent changes to the game and content will increase the number of return visits and interactions per user throughout the trial period.

XIV. DATA RESULT #2 (FINAL OUTCOME)

1. Quantitative data:

During the second testing phase, our system recorded a significant increase in traffic, with a total of 306 page views from **63 unique users**. Combining data from test 1 (85 people) and test 2 (63 people), the project reached a total of **148 active users** in just 3 days after the game's release (including both tests).

Deep engagement behavior demonstrates a shift from passive information delivery through traditional platforms to more effective interaction-based exploration. The mini-game “Kera Candy Balance” achieved the highest results with **192 interactions**, with each player completing the challenge an average of 12.8 times, demonstrating the addictive nature and excellent user retention capabilities of the game format. Additionally, the game's core objective of raising event awareness was temporarily successful through **86 event information opens** (aggregated from clicks at TV checkpoints and PDF documents), proving that students responded positively to the cleverly integrated “touchpoints” within the game.

Finally, data on user return has proven the game's ability to maintain sustained attention. Out of a total of 58 users, 30 returned to the platform (accounting for approximately 51.7%), contributing to 37 “user_returned” events. Users' willingness to return multiple times to experience content not only refreshes information but also creates a habit of voluntarily exploring events, thoroughly resolving the “email miss” issue mentioned in the overview section.

2. Qualitative insight:

Overall experience:

- Users described the game as **more “cuốn” (engaging)** because interactions felt like part of the gameplay, not “reading information.”
- The experience felt **more purposeful**: they understood “what to do” faster and stayed in the game loop longer.

What changed in engagement

- **Interaction-based checkpoints increased time-on-task**: users spent longer at checkpoints because they had to *do something* (challenge) before/while receiving the event info.
- Users were more likely to finish an interaction because it was **short, clear, and rewarding**.

Event information: visibility → stronger recall

- Users could recall **more than just visuals**; linking the event to an action made them remember the event meaning better.
- Event info felt **less like an interruption** and more like a “reward” after completing a task.

Next-step behavior (CTA)

- Users were more likely to take the next step when the CTA was **immediate and explicit** (e.g., “Register / Learn more” right after the interaction).
- They still won’t click if the event isn’t relevant, but the decision became **faster and clearer**.

Return-to-play signal (freshness)

- Rotating mini-games/content made users say they would return to:
 - + “check what’s new”
 - + try different challenges
 - + see updated campus happenings
- Variety reduced the “one-and-done” feeling and supported repeat visits.

Usability notes

- Interaction cues became easier to learn when the game consistently used the same pattern:
approach → prompt → interact → outcome/CTA
- Remaining friction points (typical):
 - + Some users still rely on exploring every corner to find hotspots
 - + Performance/loading smoothness affects how long they stay

Key takeaway: Iteration moved the product from “**discover event info**” → “**engage + remember + act + return**” by making event content interactive and keeping the experience fresh with rotating challenges.

XV. Conclusion

With the creation of *Game Phuong Mai*, Fulbright University Vietnam has transitioned from a passive information-delivery model to an active, engagement-first discovery ecosystem. Our research first revealed a crucial “attention bottleneck”: despite the vibrant campus life, students’ cognitive overload is too much for conventional communication channels like Outlook and OneStop.

During the MVP stage and later iterations, we were able to show that:

- **Gamification resolves the visibility crisis:** we attained a 51.7% return-to-play rate by framing event discovery as exploration rather than an administrative task, demonstrating that students will willingly interact with promotional content if the medium is relatable and enjoyable.
- **Interaction-based discovery boosts information retention:** as demonstrated by the Makerspace A/B test, switching from "viewing only" to "interaction-based" checkpoints increased information retention by 67%. This proves that embedding event details within mini-challenges effectively converts passive scanning into active memory.
- **Digital exploration offers measurable insights:** the system successfully tracked 86 event information interactions, providing organizers with the data-driven feedback that physical posters and booths lack.

While *Game Phương Mai* is not a replacement for formal announcements, it serves as a powerful complementary tool that captures student attention during low-effort moments. By aligning event promotion with actual student behavior, the platform effectively bridges the gap between organizers' efforts and student participation. Future development focusing on content diversity and streamlined updates will ensure the platform remains a sustainable and central pillar of the Fulbright communication landscape.